

As Emily adjusted to the Pocket Money Savings Plan, the harsh reality that she'd left herself with no money for food, petrol and pleasure soon hit home when the Bank of Dad and Mum put up the 'Sorry, Closed for Maintenance' sign. Of course, there was no way we were going to leave her to eat McDonald's scraps, but lessons had to be learned the hard way. To her credit, after thrashing around like a recently caught shark, she eventually settled down.

A good racehorse needs system and regularity in its life to relax and perform, as did Emily. The structure of our bank worked well. The pressure of having enough money to pay her bills dissipated, and the knowledge that there was some money quietly building in the background gave her confidence. Her health improved, as did her performance at work.

Not all parents are in a position to do this for their children, but there are accountants and financial advisors who will help out. When Emily reaches a certain balance of savings, the next step is to remove it from the bank and talk to a financial advisor to help her invest wisely and safely – i.e. not in high-return, risky stocks – to help the savings grow. Most advisors, from my research, suggest that a balance of at least \$10,000 is needed to start an investment plan. It's a good idea to get expert advice on investing. 'The money must do its own work' was the advice I got many years ago, and it still rings true.

We've also chatted about the type of home that Emily should buy. It's a healthy pastime, and the ideas vary depending on what opportunities shoot across our bow, but it's a good idea to start the research at this stage. For us the plan has varied from buying the worst home in the worst street in the worst suburb and then renovating to sell, to looking at apartments in trendy suburbs on Melbourne's city fringe.

Glynis and I are extremely proud of Emily. To be honest, even if she doesn't buy her home, she will have built a savings portfolio that will see her well into the future. In the not-too-distant future – probably when we do a handover to a financial advisor – we will pass the everyday running of Emily's finances back to her. She's probably now so firmly strapped into the wagon that any thought of her tumbling off it is long gone.